

FAMILY EMERGENCY COMMUNICATION PLAN

Capital City Amateur Radio Club • ARES Emergency Preparedness

★ FAMILY & HOUSEHOLD CONTACTS

PRIMARY HOUSEHOLD

Name: _____

Name: _____

Cell: _____

Cell: _____

Email: _____

Email: _____

Callsign: _____

Callsign: _____

Home/VOIP: _____

FAMILY MEMBERS

Family Member 1:	Name: _____	Cell: _____	Email: _____
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Family Member 2:	Name: _____	Cell: _____	Email: _____
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Family Member 3:	Name: _____	Cell: _____	Email: _____
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OUT-OF-AREA CONTACT

Designate someone outside your region as a central check-in point.

Name: _____

Phone: _____

Email: _____

City/State: _____

ICE — IN CASE OF EMERGENCY

Store in your phone as "ICE [Name]" — first responders know to look.

Name: _____

Phone: _____

Email: _____

City/State: _____

★ DESIGNATED MEETING PLACES

LOCAL (if home is unsafe)

Location: _____

Address: _____

REGIONAL (if you must evacuate)

Location: _____

Address: _____

★ RADIO CHECK-IN PROTOCOL (3-2-1 STANDARD)

3

Tune to **Channel 9** on CB, FRS/GMRS radios. 146.52 MHz on ham radio.

2

Attempt contact for **2 minutes before and after the top of each hour**

1

Repeat **every hour** — turn radio off between attempts to conserve battery

CCARC RADIO REFERENCE & EMERGENCY RESOURCE GUIDE

Capital City Amateur Radio Club • Lewis & Clark County, Montana

★ KEY FREQUENCIES

Frequency / Channel	Purpose / Notes
147.220 MHz, +, 100Hz	CCARC Belmont Repeater / Primary Emergency Net Frequency
147.500 MHz	CCARC primary frequency when the repeater is down
146.520 MHz	Nat'l 2m FM Simplex Calling Frequency / 3-2-1 frequency
446.000 MHz	Nat'l 70cm FM Simplex Calling Frequency
145.010 MHz	Winlink RMS Gateway at Fort Harrison
145.050 MHz	Winlink RMS alternate - try Ft Harrison first
162.400 MHz	Helena NOAA Weather Radio (7 freqs; 162.400–162.550 MHz in other areas) Broadcasts SAME alerts
CB Ch. ___ / FRS/GMRS Ch. ___ 146.52 MHz (Ham)	Family 3-2-1 Protocol — check top of each hour ±2 min
MURS Ch. 3 — 151.940	MURS license-free alternative to FRS/GMRS for 3-2-1
CB Ch. 9	Emergency CB calling channel — monitored in many areas

★ CCARC EMERGENCY NET PROCEDURE

NET CONTROL CALLS:

"QST QST QST, this is [callsign], Net Control for the Capital City Amateur Radio Club Emergency Net, now active on [frequency]. All stations with traffic please check in now by giving your callsign phonetically."

STATUS CODES:

GREEN	OK, no assistance needed
YELLOW	Minor issues, monitoring
RED	Urgent — need assistance

Follow with a CAN Report (see below) if Yellow or Red.

CHECK-IN FORMAT:

Give callsign phonetically, location, and condition (Green/Yellow/Red). Example: "Whiskey 7 Alpha Bravo Charlie, Helena North, Green."

★ GO-BAG / BUG-OUT BAG ESSENTIALS -- <https://www.ready.gov/kit>

DOCUMENTS & COMMS (waterproof as necessary)

- This comm plan (printed)
- Copies of IDs, insurance, prescriptions
- Cash in small bills, password list for important sites
- USB drive: scanned documents, passport
- CCARC freq/net reference (this card)
- Handheld radio + extra batteries

SHELTER & WARMTH

- Sleeping bag rated for season
- Emergency mylar blankets (×2)
- Change of clothes (3-day supply)
- Sturdy shoes / boots
- Rain gear / poncho
- Tent or tarp + cordage

FOOD & WATER

- Water (1 gal/person/day, min. 3 days)
- Water filter / purification tablets
- Non-perishable food (3-day min.)
- Manual can opener
- Camp stove + fuel

HEALTH & SAFETY

- Prescription meds (7-day supply)
- First aid kit
- N95 masks
- Hand sanitizer + soap
- Flashlight / headlamp + batteries
- Multi-tool / knife
- Whistle, duct tape, zip ties
- Phone charger + solar/power bank

⚠ Review and rotate supplies every 6 months. Keep the bag near your exit. Also prepare a 2-week shelter-in-place supply at home.

★ KEY RESOURCES

Lewis & Clark Co. DES	lccountymt.gov/des • (406) 447-8223
Montana DES	mtdes.mt.gov • (406) 324-4777
FEMA Ready.gov	ready.gov • Build a Kit / Make a Plan / Stay Informed
ARRL ARES / EmComm	arrl.org/ares • Emergency Communications resources
Winlink Global Radio Email	winlink.org • Email via radio when internet is down
RAVE Alert (Lewis & Clark Co.)	Register for reverse-911 emergency notifications https://lccountymt.gov/Emergency-Management/Emergency-Notification-Smart911
Jefferson County - 'Everbridge' Alerting System	https://member.everbridge.net/88752814817480/login

CAN
REPORT

Conditions • **A**ctions • **N**eeds

Example: "We are okay. House has minor damage. We're fixing a water leak. Nothing needed now."

Text first — calls are brief, conveying only vital info. Wait 10 seconds before redialing. Reduce screen brightness, enable airplane mode between uses. Keep a car charger and solar charger available.

★ Training Plan - Optional list of training courses to get prepared for communicating during an emergency

Course Name	Description	Reference	Date Completed
IS-100.c	FEMA's Introduction to the Incident Command System (ICS)	https://training.fema.gov/	
IS-200.c	ICS for Single Resources and Initial Action Incidents	https://training.fema.gov/	
IS-700.b	Intro to the National Incident Management System (NIMS)	https://training.fema.gov/	
ARRL EC-001	Introduction to Emergency Communication	https://arrl.org/online-course-catalog	
Winlink Training Exercise	Send and receive a Winlink message successfully at least once before an activation. No formal course, just practice.	https://winlink.org/tags/tutorial	
Skywarn Spotter Training	A free National Weather Service-run course, great for weather-aware operators	Contact NWS Great Falls office for training opportunities	
Run a Net	Volunteer to run ARES or Coffee Net to learn net control duties.		

Capital City Amateur Radio Club (n7rb.org) — Prepared for our families, ready for our community.